

Slide 5: Technical Infrastructure

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WikiLeaks' technical infrastructure has evolved significantly since its inception to ensure security and resilience:

Distributed Hosting

WikiLeaks employs a strategy of "jurisdictional arbitrage," hosting content on multiple servers across various countries to exploit legal discrepancies and maintain availability^[1]. This includes using underground facilities like the Pionen data center in Stockholm, a former Cold War nuclear bunker^[2].

Redundancy and Security

- Content stored on over 20 servers worldwide
- Hundreds of domain names used for access
- Employs the Tor network for anonymous submissions^[2:1]

Submission System

- Rebuilt by "The Architect" for improved security^[1:1]
- Temporarily offline from 2010 to 2015 due to technical issues and alleged sabotage^[1:2]
- Current status limited due to legal challenges and funding restrictions^[1:3]

DDoS Protection

WikiLeaks has faced numerous denial-of-service attacks, leading to frequent changes in hosting providers, including brief stints with Amazon Web Services and OVH^[3].

Encryption and Anonymity

- Uses advanced encryption for data protection
- Leverages anonymizing networks like Tor for secure communications^[4]

Backup Measures

WikiLeaks has released "insurance files" - encrypted backups of its data - as a precautionary measure against potential takedown attempts^[1:4].



1. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/WikiLeaks>

2. https://communicationstudies.uiowa.edu/sites/communicationstudies.uiowa.edu/files/2022-06/Zajacz_WikiLeaks_Media_Culture_and_Society.pdf

3. <https://www.datacenterdynamics.com/en/news/wikileaks-publishes-list-aws-data-center-locations-colorado-providers/>
4. https://wikileaks.org/ciav7p1/cms/page_15368208.html